

Cisco Cloud Control with AI Canvas FAQs

This article addresses common questions regarding Cisco Cloud Control, AI Canvas, Cloud Control Marketplace and Cloud Control Studio. Last updated: August 20, 2026.

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Strategic Visions and AgenticOps

Why did Cisco build Cisco Cloud Control?

Cisco Cloud Control is Cisco's strategic response to one of enterprise IT's most persistent challenges: fragmented operations across disconnected management planes.

Customers manage increasingly complex environments spanning networking, security, observability, collaboration, compute, and cloud. Operational teams often have to move between multiple consoles to understand inventory, correlate events, troubleshoot incidents, enforce policy, and demonstrate compliance. This fragmentation slows response, increases operational risk, creates inconsistent visibility, and makes it harder for IT teams to deliver predictable outcomes.

Cisco Cloud Control establishes a unified operational layer across Cisco's portfolio. It provides a single starting point for visibility, insights, workflows, and agentic operations while preserving customers' investments in the purpose-built controllers used within each domain. By connecting portfolio context, identity, data, and workflows, Cloud Control

helps customers reduce complexity, improve time to insight and resolution, and establish a governed foundation for agentic operations.

Why Cisco? What makes us different in comparison to our competitors?

Cisco brings decades of product depth across networking, security, compute, observability, and collaboration. Cisco Cloud Control connects that depth so products can contribute context, intelligence, and action to a broader operational environment.

Each product retains its specialized capabilities and management experience. Cisco Cloud Control adds the shared foundation needed to work across them. Supported partner and third-party systems extend that environment without requiring customers to replace the tools that already meet their needs.

What makes it different is:

- Portfolio depth becomes a cross-domain advantage: Cisco Cloud Control connects context and action across networking, security, compute, observability, and collaboration, helping teams understand dependencies, find cause and impact faster, and resolve issues that span IT domains.
- The foundation is connected, not just the interface: Shared identity, inventory, topology, telemetry, policy, and action create a consistent operational foundation. Products, apps, and agents can build on it without recreating core services or operational context.
- Product depth is preserved: Teams keep the specialized capabilities and management experiences they rely on while gaining shared context across products.
- It is built for teams and AI agents: Operators and agents work from the same trusted context, permissions, and tools, helping teams investigate faster, reduce handoff friction, and act with appropriate oversight.
- It adapts to the customer: Organizations can build custom apps and agents and connect supported third-party systems, adding capabilities around their needs without replacing existing tools and investments.

What does "platform" mean in the context of Cisco Cloud Control?

Cisco Cloud Control is more than a navigation portal.

A portal primarily helps users move between tools. Cloud Control adds shared platform services such as identity and tenant context, normalized inventory and topology, cross-domain operational context, and AI-assisted workflows.

This gives NetOps, SecOps, infrastructure, and platform teams a common operating layer for understanding what they have, how it is connected, what is changing, what needs attention, and what action to take next. Purpose-built controllers retain their domain depth, while Cloud Control reduces the need to connect their data and workflows manually.

How is AgenticOps different from traditional AIOps?

Traditional AIOps focuses on detection and insight with AI to correlate events, reduce noise, and surface recommendations. In practice, it often stops at alerts or suggested actions, which leaves teams to manually coordinate next steps across tools and domains. AgenticOps goes further by coordination of the full operational workflow. AI agents actively gather evidence, maintain context, and help drive work end-to-end—from investigation through approved action and validation, while humans retain control at all times. The result is faster, more continuous operations with governance, accountability, and auditability built in.

How do Cisco Cloud Control and AI Canvas fit together?

Think of Cloud Control as the harness and AI Canvas as the situation room inside it. Cloud Control provides the foundation every team works from with one login, unified inventory, shared topology, correlated alerts, and governed identity. AI Canvas is where agents operate: a collaborative workspace where operators and AI agents investigate and resolve cross-domain issues together. You always start in Cloud Control. When an issue needs deeper investigation or team collaboration, you open Canvas and it inherits all of Cloud Control's context automatically. Cloud Control without Canvas is a unified platform. Canvas without Cloud Control is a clever workspace. Together, they're an operating agentic workspace.

Is AI Canvas a standalone product?

No, AI Canvas is not a standalone product. It is an experience within Cisco Cloud Control.

What is the pitch to a customer who only has one Cisco domain today?

Even for a single domain, Cisco Cloud Control can create value when the customer operates that domain at scale.

If a customer has multiple environments, tenants, regions, or operating teams within one domain, they still need a unified management plane. Cisco Cloud Control gives them a

shared workspace through AI Canvas where operators and AI agents can investigate issues together using natural language, persistent context, and agentic execution across that environment. That improves collaboration, reduces handoffs, supports consistent identity and access, and gives teams a single place to coordinate operational work.

If the footprint stays single-domain, the value remains in day-to-day operations and better coordination at scale. If the customer later adopts more Cisco products, that same foundation expands naturally with more telemetry, broader context, and cross-domain reasoning."

How do we pitch the high-level vision without indication of a future promise or "vaporware"?

Position Cisco Cloud Control and AI Canvas as the "Present" chapter of IT evolution. The past was Manual Operations (fragmented tools). The future is Ambient Proactive Action (fully autonomous AI). Today, we deliver Governed Agentic Operations or AI agents that can execute complex workflows alongside humans with full governance and oversight.

Doing a live demo of Cloud Control, hosted in dCloud, is the best way to dispel any skepticism about the capabilities and value of Cloud Control.

Understand Cisco Cloud Control, AI Canvas, AI Assistant, Cloud Control Studio and Cloud Control Marketplace

Cisco Cloud Control

What is Cisco Cloud Control?

Cisco Cloud Control is the unified operations platform for AgenticOps. It brings the Cisco estate and connected third-party systems into one operational environment, giving teams and AI agents the context and control to manage infrastructure, resolve issues across IT domains, and extend the platform with custom apps, agents, and integrations.

All of the experiences live within Cisco Cloud Control – including but not limited to: Cisco AI Canvas, Cisco AI Assistant, Cloud Control Studio, and Cloud Control Marketplace.

What key pain points does Cisco Cloud Control solve?

- Management is fragmented. Teams work across separate sign-ins, inventories, interfaces, and operating processes.
- Context breaks at product boundaries. Identity, assets, topology, telemetry, and investigation history do not consistently follow the operator, creating context dead zones.

- Cross-domain issues take too long to resolve. Teams must manually connect symptoms, dependencies, and ownership across products and IT domains.
- AI agents lack operational grounding. Without trusted access, live context, authorized tools, and safeguards, agents cannot safely help with real infrastructure.
- Customizing operations takes too much work. Building tailored capabilities and connecting existing tools often requires separate development and integration efforts.

What are the key, high-level features of Cisco Cloud Control?

- One login and seamless navigation: A consistent way to move across connected Cisco products without reauthentication or losing operational context.
- Unified control plane: One operational layer for managing inventory, topology, identity, and policy across the Cisco estate.
- Cross-domain context: Connected signals, assets, health, and dependencies across products and IT domains.
- Operational harness: Trusted access, authorized tools, policy boundaries, and safeguards for AI agents working with real infrastructure.
- Built-in extensibility: Cloud Control Studio for custom apps, agents, and tool connections, plus Cloud Control Marketplace for Cisco and ecosystem capabilities.

What are the key outcomes to expect from Cisco Cloud Control?

- Move across products more easily. Spend less time signing in, switching tools, and rebuilding context.
- Manage with greater consistency. Work from shared inventory, topology, identity, and policy across the Cisco estate.
- Resolve issues faster. Understand how signals, assets, and dependencies connect so teams can focus on the underlying problem.
- Put AI agents to work with confidence. Let agents investigate and carry out authorized actions with shared context, clear controls, and appropriate oversight.
- Adapt without replacing what works. Customize the platform around organizational needs while preserving existing tools and technology investments.

AI Canvas

What is AI Canvas?

AI Canvas is the multiplayer, agentic workspace within Cisco Cloud Control where operators and AI agents investigate, decide, and act together. It keeps evidence and context in one place so teams can find cause and impact faster, continue across handoffs without starting over, and move from investigation to approved action.

What key pain points does AI Canvas solve?

- Investigations are scattered. Evidence, findings, decisions, and actions are spread across different tools and conversations.
- Cause and impact stay hidden. Individual products may show symptoms without revealing dependencies across IT domains.
- Handoffs reset the work. Teams lose investigation history when an issue moves between operators, shifts, or specialized teams.
- Action stalls after investigation. Teams lack a clear path from findings and recommendations to approved action.

What are the key, high-level features of AI Canvas?

- Multiplayer workspace: One live environment where operators and AI agents work together from the same evidence and operational context.
- Cross-domain investigation: Agent-led analysis and correlation across products and IT domains.
- Persistent context: A durable record of evidence, findings, decisions, and actions across sessions and handoffs.
- Governed action: A controlled path for reviewing recommendations, approving next steps, and carrying out authorized actions.

What are the key outcomes to expect from AI Canvas?

- Bring investigations together. Spend less time switching tools, gathering evidence, and coordinating separate conversations.
- Find cause and impact faster. Reveal relationships across products and IT domains that individual tools may not show.
- Keep work moving through handoffs. Continue across teams and shifts without repeating work or rebuilding the investigation.

- Reach resolution with control. Move from findings to approved actions while keeping operators involved in important decisions.

What does it mean that AI Canvas is a "multiplayer" workspace?

AI Canvas provides a shared, synchronized workspace where operators and AI agents can work from the same evidence, findings, notes, and investigation history. The workspace preserves context across collaboration and handoffs so another operator can continue the investigation without reconstructing the work from the beginning.

What are widgets in AI Canvas and how are they organized?

Widgets are the visual building blocks on the AI Canvas workspace. Each widget represents a specific piece of operational information such as a network overview, a device detail view, a topology map, a health assessment, or a compliance report. Widgets are color-coded by type (for example, networks, topologies, health assessments, security) to help operators quickly identify and organize them. Widgets can be collapsed, stacked by category, extracted from stacks, resized to full screen, and arranged on the canvas. Operators choose which items to promote to widgets on the canvas with a plus-sign control, in order to keep the workspace focused on what matters for the current investigation rather than automatic population of it with every query result.

Can customers bring their own knowledge documents into AI Canvas?

Yes. AI Canvas supports customer-uploaded knowledge sources that can be referenced during investigations. Customers can upload documents such as network contact lists, outage histories, SLA details, ISP information, or operational runbooks. These documents are then available to be pulled into any prompt using a hashtag command, which allows the AI to incorporate the customer's own organizational context when it answers questions or during performance analysis.

What is deep thinking mode in AI Canvas?

Deep thinking is an investigation mode in AI Canvas that performs a thorough, multi-step analysis of a problem. When invoked, it creates a dedicated investigation environment, builds an execution plan, gathers evidence across available data sources, writes and runs analytical code, and produces a comprehensive report which includes primary cause, contributing factors, impact assessment, and an evidence trail. Deep thinking takes longer than a quick analysis (typically a few minutes) but provides significantly more depth and rigor. Operators can choose between deep reason and quick analysis based on the complexity of the issue.

Does AI Canvas support multimodal input such as images?

AI Canvas includes a vision analysis agent that can interpret images. Operators can capture a screenshot, such as a topology map or a dashboard view, and drop it into the AI Canvas chat. The vision analysis agent inventories the contents of the image, creates metadata, compares it with known network context, and provides an analysis. For example, an operator could screenshot a topology and ask "Do we have any problems in this network?" and receive an informed response based on both the image and live platform data.

Does AI Canvas generate downloadable reports and artifacts?

Yes. AI Canvas supports artifacts downloads such as topology maps as PDFs, compliance audit reports, and other investigation outputs. Operators can export these for documentation, share with stakeholders, or offline review.

AI Assistant

What is AI Assistant?

AI Assistant is the context-aware, natural-language assistant within Cisco Cloud Control that helps operators get answers and complete everyday tasks. It combines product knowledge with operational context to help teams understand issues, identify next steps, and continue complex investigations in AI Canvas without starting over.

What key pain points does AI Assistant solve?

- Answers are difficult to find. Operators spend time searching across documentation, interfaces, and information sources.
- Answers lack operational context. Generic responses do not reflect the assets, events, and conditions affecting the environment.
- Everyday tasks take too many steps. Routine work requires unnecessary navigation and manual coordination.
- Escalations start over. Context is lost when an everyday question becomes a more complex investigation.

What are the key, high-level features of AI Assistant?

- Natural-language access: A conversational way to ask questions and request help across Cisco Cloud Control.
- Context-aware answers: Responses grounded in product knowledge and relevant operational information.

- Everyday task assistance: Guidance, recommended next steps, and support for completing common work.
- AI Canvas handoff: A direct path into deeper investigation with the relevant conversation and operational context intact.

What are the key outcomes to expect from AI Assistant?

- Find answers faster. Spend less time searching through documentation, interfaces, and information sources.
- Make better-informed decisions. Use answers grounded in the environment and issue at hand.
- Move everyday work forward. Complete common tasks with fewer steps and less manual navigation.
- Escalate without repeating yourself. Continue complex work in AI Canvas with the relevant context intact.

Is the AI Assistant across all Cisco platforms?

Yes. Cisco Cloud Control includes a Unified AI Assistant—a global, natural language interface that works across every integrated Cisco product. It uses a federated approach that connects to each product's native intelligence and skills, allowing it to answer questions and take action across Cisco's entire portfolio from a single, persistent chat experience within Cloud Control.

When should I tell my customer to use AI Assistant vs. AI Canvas?

Use AI Assistant for quick, single-player questions, such as "What's the health of my Chicago branch?" or "Show me devices approaching end-of-support." Use AI Canvas for deeper, multi-step, or multi-team investigations, such as "Why is our finance app slow today, and what do we do about it?" If an operator starts in Assistant and realizes they need more, one click escalates into Canvas with full context preserved. Assistant is for seconds-to-minutes conversations while Canvas is for minutes-to-hours investigations. Both use the same reasoning engine, so answers stay consistent regardless of where the question is asked.

Cloud Control Marketplace

What is Cloud Control Marketplace?

Cloud Control Marketplace is the ecosystem within Cisco Cloud Control where organizations discover and adopt apps, agents, and integrations from Cisco, partners, and

third parties. It helps teams add capabilities faster, bring supported non-Cisco tools and context into Cisco Cloud Control, and continue using the specialized products they already rely on.

What key pain points does Cloud Control Marketplace solve?

- Vendor lock-in limits choice. Teams may be forced to stay within one ecosystem or replace tools that already meet their needs.
- Integrations take too much work. Connecting systems often requires custom development and ongoing maintenance.
- Disconnected systems limit cross-domain operations. Capabilities available in one tool may not be accessible where broader operational work happens.
- Tools do not share context. Important data, tools, and actions remain isolated from teams and AI agents.

What are the key, high-level features of Cloud Control Marketplace?

- Cisco and multi-vendor ecosystem: Additional apps, agents, and integrations from Cisco, partners, and third parties.
- Central discovery and adoption: One place to find and add available capabilities to Cisco Cloud Control.
- Ecosystem integrations: Available connections that reduce the need to build every integration from the beginning.
- In-platform access: Adopted capabilities available within Cisco Cloud Control and AI Canvas where supported.

What are the key outcomes to expect from Cloud Control Marketplace?

- Preserve technology choice. Continue using specialized tools that already meet the organization's needs.
- Add capabilities faster. Reduce the time and effort required to find, evaluate, and adopt new solutions.
- Connect more of the environment. Bring supported partner and third-party capabilities into Cisco Cloud Control and AI Canvas.
- Work with broader context. Give teams and AI agents more of the relevant data, tools, and actions needed to understand and resolve issues.

Cisco Cloud Control Studio

What is Cloud Control Studio?

Cloud Control Studio is the build environment within Cisco Cloud Control where organizations create custom apps and agents for the way they operate. Teams can connect existing systems, equip apps and agents with reusable skills drawn from runbooks and policies, and test capabilities before deployment.

What key pain points does Cloud Control Studio solve?

- Generic automation does not fit every organization. Standard tools cannot reflect every team's systems, policies, runbooks, and operating practices.
- Operational expertise stays trapped. Important knowledge remains in documents, manual processes, and individual teams.
- Connections must be rebuilt. Teams repeatedly integrate the same data, tools, and automation for different use cases.
- Custom apps and agents are difficult to operationalize. Teams need a consistent way to build, test, deploy, and manage them.

What are the key, high-level features of Cloud Control Studio?

- App Builder and Agent Builder: Dedicated environments for creating custom apps and agents.
- Reusable skills: Organizational runbooks, procedures, and policies packaged for use by apps and agents.
- Tool connections: Supported integrations with data, third-party systems, APIs, MCP services, and existing automation.
- Development lifecycle: Testing, refinement, versioning, publishing, and deployment within Cisco Cloud Control.

What are the key outcomes to expect from Cloud Control Studio?

- Build faster for specific needs. Create capabilities that reflect the organization's systems, processes, and ways of working.
- Scale expertise beyond individual teams. Make proven knowledge and operating practices available wherever they are needed.

- Reduce repeated integration work. Reuse existing data, tools, and automation across apps, agents, and use cases.
- Move into operations with confidence. Validate and refine custom capabilities before making them available to operators.

What if I have further questions about Studio, App Builder or Agent Builder?

Visit the Ask Cisco Cloud Control space: <https://eurl.io/#X1dt23319>

App builder in Cloud Control Studio

What is App Builder in Cloud Control Studio?

App Builder is one of two builder environments inside Cloud Control Studio. It lets customers and partners build and publish apps and workflows for Cisco Cloud Control from natural-language prompts, with built-in agentic coding assistants starting with OpenAI Codex. Users describe what they need in plain language, and App Builder creates the application.

What makes App Builder different from other AI coding tools?

Most AI coding tools stop at code generation — they hand you files and leave the hard part to you. An application built in App Builder is "born deployed": it is automatically authenticated with Cisco identity, registered, hosted, and ready to distribute the moment it is created. The agent is the engine; App Builder is everything Cisco layers around it — identity, services, hosting, governance, and distribution.

How does App Builder work? Do I need development experience to use App Builder?

Tell it what you want in plain language, and it builds the application, lets you preview it, and ships it as a working app that runs directly inside Cisco Cloud Control. There is no infrastructure to provision, no build tools to install, and no plumbing to learn.

The intended experience is natural-language app creation. Users describe what they need, and App Builder creates the app. No coding is required.

What can I build with App Builder?

The range is wide, including:

Custom operational views: A single screen combining alerts, device health, and fix-it actions during an outage, instead of clicking across separate consoles. Data and tools for the AI assistant: Connect your own workflows (e.g., change-approval) to Cisco's AI assistant so engineers can issue natural-language commands that route through proper

approvals. Unified integrations: Pull third-party data into Cloud Control or push Cisco signals out to external systems. Partner-built customer experiences: Branded experiences that run directly in Cloud Control, extending Cisco's platform to serve a partner's own customers. "

Is this the same as a Codex Plugin?

No. Do not describe the capability as a Codex Plugin. The approved framing is App Builder powered by OpenAI Codex inside Cisco Cloud Control.

Can I build external to Cisco Cloud Control and then bring it into the platform?

App Builder is the 'no code' way of building apps. For individuals who are comfortable writing their own code or using a dedicated coding agent, there are other experiences planned for the future for building and deploying apps on Cisco's platform.

Can I use App Builder with AI models other than OpenAI Codex?

Currently, only OpenAI Codex models are provided.

Can App Builder work beyond Cisco products?

Cisco Cloud Control is expanding to third parties so apps can run actions across the customer's broader ecosystem. At launch, keep expectations high-level unless a specific third-party workflow has been confirmed.

How are product-level permissions handled when the app creator is different from the end-user?

Applications typically access Cisco product data on behalf of the user logged into Cloud Control, following industry standard OAuth patterns. This ensures that the application cannot see or access data that the logged in user cannot.

What are the fees for using App Builder?

Pricing and packaging information is not yet available.

How does governance work for apps built in App Builder?

Cloud Control is the governance and access surface. Apps use Cisco's unified identity and operate through the Cloud Control experience, with telemetry, permissions, logging, and compliance controls built in rather than creating unmanaged paths around Cisco controls.

Once I build an app, how do I distribute it?

Apps built in Studio can be published to Cloud Control Marketplace, where they become visible and available to Cisco Cloud Control users. Apps are ready to distribute the moment they are created.

When will App Builder be available?

Cisco will work closely with design partners prior to kicking off a formal beta program. If you have a customer that you would like to nominate to be a design partner, reach out to the App Builder product management team with details on specific customer use cases.

Agent Builder in Cloud Control Studio

What is Agent Builder?

Agent Builder is the second builder environment inside Cloud Control Studio. It lets customers build customer agents in natural language tailored to their own policies and workflows. Customers can connect agents to third-party tools and create custom agent skills from operational knowledge resources (like SOPs or runbooks).

How do agents that are built in Agent Builder run in Cisco Cloud Control?

Agents built in Cloud Control Studio run in one of two modes, chosen by the publisher when the agent is configured.

Ambient agents run continuously in Cisco Cloud Control. They operate in the background, monitoring data, watching for conditions, and acting or alerting when something happens. Ambient agents run on their own schedule or in response to events. Operators don't need to be in a session for them to work and will be notified if the agent requires input or approval from them. Live agents are invoked during sessions in Cisco AI Canvas. They work alongside operators in real time on active investigations. Live agents respond to the work happening in the session and exit when the work is done.

Who builds agents in the Agent Builder?

Studio is for Cisco Cloud Control users including IT admins, network operations teams, and partners who need custom workflows, dashboards, agents, operational apps, or action-oriented experiences that reflect their business environment, without requiring them to write code.

The intent is that the people closest to the operational problem, not specialized AI engineers, build the agents that solve it. A network operator who knows the right way to triage a Wi-Fi outage can encode that knowledge into an agent. A SecOps lead who knows their organization's incident response sequence can build that into an ambient agent.

Cisco Cloud Control Studio is designed for the operators who run the environment, not for a separate AI development team.

How is Agent Builder in Cloud Control Studio different from building AI agents with LangChain or a custom framework?

Generic AI agent frameworks give developers raw tools. Building production-ready agents on those frameworks means assembling integrations, governance, observability, evaluation, deployment, and version control from separate components, then maintaining all of it.

Cisco Cloud Control Studio includes those layers natively:

Built-in governance. Cisco AI Defense enforces policy at runtime. Approval gates and human-in-the-loop are first-class. Built-in observability. Splunk AI Agent Monitoring traces every agent execution. No separate monitoring stack to deploy. Built-in evaluation. Splunk AI Agent Monitoring (via Galileo) automatically scores output quality and flags hallucinations. No separate eval pipeline. Built-in deployment. Sandbox, version control, and publish workflows are part of the platform. Native data and tool access. Agents reach the customer's Cisco environment, third-party tools, and custom skills without custom integration code.

A team building on LangChain might spend months assembling all of this before their first agent goes to production. In Cisco Cloud Control Studio, the platform is the assembly. Builders focus on the agent logic, not the infrastructure underneath it.

Which third-party tools can I connect to Agent Builder?

Cisco Cloud Control Studio offers native integrations for common enterprise tools, such as ServiceNow. Native integrations are pre-built, validated, and configured through a guided setup, so customers don't write integration code. You can read the current list at www.cisco.com/go/CloudControlStudio in the FAQ

For any tool that doesn't have a native integration, Cisco Cloud Control Studio would support connecting to Application Programming Interface (API) or open Model Context Protocol (MCP). Customers and partners can build MCP connectors themselves or use connectors built by others.

Once connected, a tool's data and actions become available to AI agents working across Cisco Cloud Control, including inside Cisco AI Canvas. When an operator investigates an issue, AI agents can pull context from connected tools, correlate it with Cisco's own data, and propose remediations that reach across the customer's full environment.

What is an "agent skill" in Agent Builder?

A skill is a piece of operational logic an AI agent can call, such as a runbook procedure, a remediation step, a diagnostic check, or a policy validation. Skills can be simple (run a specific check, return a status) or complex (execute a multi-step procedure with conditional logic).

Skills are reusable across agents. Encoding a procedure once makes it available to every agent that needs it. A skill that captures the customer's standard approach to firewall rule validation can be called by a security agent, a compliance agent, and a network change agent. The same logic, called from different agents in different contexts.

Skills are managed in Cloud Control Studio with version control. As the customer's operational practices evolve, skills are updated centrally, and every agent that uses them inherits the change.

How are agents built in Agent Builder monitored and evaluated?

Every agent run, trace, failure, and quality score is powered by Splunk AI Agent Monitoring and Galileo, both included with Cisco Cloud Control Studio. No separate tools or subscriptions required.

Splunk AI Agent Monitoring captures execution data: every agent run, with outcome (success, warning, failed), duration, and trigger source. Builders can drill into traces showing each LLM call, tool invocation, and skill execution, with inputs and outputs. Failures (error codes, authorization issues, tool timeouts) surface in context on the agent's detail page.

Splunk AI Agent Monitoring (via Galileo) evaluates output quality: it scores agent outputs for accuracy, relevance, and correctness using LLM-as-a-judge methodology. It flags hallucinations, where agents fabricate information or cite unsupported data. It also detects drift, alerting builders when an agent's quality degrades over time.

Together, observability and evaluation give builders a closed loop: see what agents did, see how well they did it, and improve them.

How are agents built in Agent Builder governed and controlled?

Every agent runs under policy enforcement through Cisco AI Defense at both build time and runtime. Customers define what each agent can do, when it can act, and what actions require human approval. Agents propose actions; humans approve before anything changes on production.

Can I get deeper analytics across my agents beyond what's included in Agent Builder?

Yes. Customers can cross-launch directly into Splunk for the full monitoring experience: fleet-wide dashboards across all agents, custom queries and alerting rules, long-term trace retention for compliance and auditing, and correlation with infrastructure metrics (network, compute, application) already in Splunk.

The cross-launch is one click from Cloud Control Studio. For customers who already use Splunk, agent telemetry becomes part of the broader operational picture. For customers without a Splunk subscription, the in-platform observability included with Cloud Control Studio covers the essentials.

How are agents tested before they go live in Agent Builder?

Agents go through a draft, sandbox, and publish lifecycle before they can act on production.

Draft. The agent is being built. The builder describes what it should do, configures its tools and skills, and iterates on its logic. **Sandbox.** The agent runs against real data in a sandbox environment. Builders can simulate scenarios, observe the agent's behavior, review traces, and verify that outputs meet quality expectations. **Publish.** Once the builder is satisfied, the agent is published with a version number. Publishing requires an approval gate. From there, the agent is available to run in its configured mode (ambient or live).

Version control tracks every change. Customers can roll back to a prior version if a new version causes issues, and full execution history is preserved across versions for auditing and comparison.

How is Agent Builder relate to Cloud Control Marketplace?

Agent Builder is the second builder environment inside Cloud Control Studio. It lets customers build custom agents in natural language tailored to their own policies and workflows. Customers can connect agents to third-party tools and create custom agent skills from operational knowledge resources (like SOPs or runbooks).

Can I upload my runbooks and operational knowledge to Agent Builder?

Yes. Customers can upload runbooks, SOPs, policies, and operational knowledge to a local knowledge base inside Cisco Cloud Control Studio. Supported formats include common document types (PDF, Word, Markdown, plain text) and structured formats. Once uploaded, content is indexed and converted into reusable agent skills.

Skills derived from uploaded knowledge work the same way as any other skill: AI agents can call them during investigations and remediations in Cisco AI Canvas, and they can be reused across multiple agents. The customer's operational expertise becomes executable.

The knowledge base is local to the customer's tenancy. Uploaded content stays within the customer's environment and is not shared with other customers or used to train external models.

Does my data leave my environment when I use Agent Builder?

Customer-uploaded knowledge stays within the customer's tenancy in Cisco Cloud Control and is governed by Cisco's enterprise security and privacy controls. Customers control what data is accessible to which agents.

How is Agent Builder licensed?

Cisco Cloud Control Studio is not yet available. Licensing and packaging have not yet been announced.

How is Agent Builder different from a workflow automation tool?

Workflow automation tools execute predefined steps. Given a trigger, they run a script that has been written in advance. The logic is static. If conditions change, the script either fails or produces the wrong result.

Cisco Cloud Control Studio builds AI agents that reason across data, decide what to do, and propose actions to humans for approval. The work is dynamic and context-aware, not script-based.

A concrete example: a workflow automation tool can be configured to restart a service when CPU exceeds a threshold. An AI agent can investigate why CPU is high, correlate it with recent deployments, network conditions, and security events, identify the root cause, and propose either a service restart or a different remediation depending on what the data actually shows. The agent reasons about the situation. The workflow tool just runs.

Agents and workflows are complementary. Workflows are still the right answer for fully predictable, low-variance tasks. Agents are the right answer when the work requires judgment, cross-domain context, or adaptation to conditions that weren't known when the logic was written.

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How will licensing and pricing work?

At Launch, licensing for Cisco Cloud Control with AI Canvas is included with your subscription license for eligible Cisco products at no additional cost. Customers who maintain active subscriptions to any one of Cisco's integrated products receive full access to Cloud Control once it's available to that customer.

While the Advantage tier includes all functionality found in Essentials, it is designed to house additional high-value features. Currently, core capabilities are available in both tiers; however, future advanced capabilities will be bundled exclusively into the Advantage tier. Customers pay for the products they use (Meraki, Nexus, Security, etc.), and Cloud Control unifies them at no extra charge.

Cisco reserves the right to adjust Cloud Control platform pricing in the future.

What is the token consumption model and pricing for AI Canvas usage?

At U.S. General Availability (August 25, 2026), every customer receives an included allocation of AI Canvas tokens at no additional cost, enabling their teams to begin using AI Canvas immediately and demonstrate value quickly. This included allocation is part of the platform feature set bundled with your subscription licenses for eligible Cisco products. Expansion pricing for token usage beyond the included allocation is currently being finalized and will be communicated as it becomes available.

Cisco reserves the right to adjust platform usage pricing in the future, but there is no plan to monetize AI Canvas or Cisco Cloud Control at launch. For the most current information on token allocation details and expansion pricing, check SalesConnect or contact your Cisco Sales representative.

What qualifies as an "eligible Cisco product" for Cisco Cloud Control and AI Canvas entitlement?

Eligibility is tied to active subscription licenses on integrated Cisco products. A customer with an active subscription to any one of these products is entitled to Cloud Control at no additional cost. Perpetual-only customers without active subscriptions are not currently eligible. For specific SKU-level eligibility, contact your Cisco Sales representative.

Are there plans to offer AI Canvas as a standalone product?

Currently, AI Canvas is bundled with Cisco platform subscriptions. There are no plans to offer it as a standalone product.

What is the licensing model for AI Canvas?

All AI Canvas "skills" are currently included with existing product subscriptions (Essentials and Advantage). Cisco reserves the right to monetize advanced skills in the future.

Architecture, integrations, and data flow

Where can I find the list of products integrated into Cisco Cloud Control?

You can find it here. This is INTERNAL ONLY.

Link:

<https://cisco.sharepoint.com/:p:/s/AISoftwareandPlatformTeam/IQCLYUPvCgRNQbv6s3plSoAGAQW-AOO6S0i85Uq4vINHULE?e=rsc1r>

This document can also be found under “Ideal Customer Profiles (ICP)” on the Cisco Cloud Control with AI Canvas SalesConnect page.

What is Cisco Cloud Control not?

Cloud Control is not an ITSM platform and it doesn't replace ServiceNow or Jira. It is not a SIEM and it doesn't replace Splunk. It is not a SOAR tool, although it complements one. It is not a replacement for individual Cisco product controllers and those remain fully functional. It is the operations layer that unifies and adds agentic intelligence on top of all of these.

Is Cisco Cloud Control just a redesigned UI or another portal on top of Cisco's current tools?

No. While Cloud Control provides a modern, unified navigation experience, it also includes platform-layer services such as unified identity, normalized inventory, an AI Assistant that provides consistent, context-aware guidance across every domain, and AI Canvas. Cisco Cloud Control therefore lets you operate as if the tools were one system, a fundamentally different category. See "What does "platform" mean in the context of Cisco Cloud Control?" for more background.

How does Cisco Cloud Control get data from the individual products?

Cloud Control uses a combination of push and pull mechanisms based on the product. Some products push data proactively to Cloud Control, while others require Cloud Control to pull data via APIs. The platform uses Cisco Unified Identity-based tokens to authenticate and authorize these data exchanges. In order to continually reduce time to insight and resolution, the goal is for all data to flow as close to real-time as possible and to enable meaningful cross-domain correlation.

How does Cisco Cloud Control keep inventory and operational data current?

Synchronization varies by source and generally occurs from every few minutes to once an hour. Most products push data to Cloud Control. If connectivity is lost, Cloud Control retains the last-synchronized inventory but cannot update it until connectivity returns. Decommissioned devices must be removed from the source controller before they disappear from Cloud Control.

What does "log in once" actually mean?

Single sign-on; Customers authenticate once using Cisco's unified identity services and can move across integrated Cisco products in Cloud Control without repeated logins, while still honoring entitlements and product-level role-based access controls.

What is tenant linking and why does it matter to my customer?

Most customers have multiple Cisco product tenants, such as one for Meraki, one for Security Cloud Control, one for ThousandEyes, and so on. Tenant linking is how an administrator connects those tenants into a single unified Cloud Control experience. An admin does this once. From that point forward, every user in the organization gets single sign-on, one unified inventory, one topology, and one alerting view across every linked product without each user configuring anything individually. It's the foundational step that turns a collection of Cisco products into a unified operations environment.

How can an existing tenant-group link be changed?

File a TAC case from within Cisco Cloud Control. TAC will coordinate with engineering to change or remove the existing tenant-group linking.

What network access is required to open an on-premises controller from Cisco Cloud Control?

The user's browser must be able to reach the controller's private management address. This typically requires being on the same customer network or connected through VPN. Cloud Control does not make a private controller address publicly reachable.

How does Cisco Cloud Control's data enhance AI Canvas?

Cloud Control aggregates and normalizes inventory, topology, and telemetry from across Cisco's portfolio. This data is exposed to AI Canvas through Model Context Protocol services, which gives AI Canvas rich, cross-domain context about every asset in a customer's environment which includes other devices, relationships, and topology. This means when AI Canvas investigates an issue, it already understands the full operational landscape, which enables faster and more accurate cross-domain reason without the requirement of operators to manually provide context.

Does every connected controller expose the same inventory, advisory, topology, and action data?

No. Data depth and supported actions vary by controller, product release, entitlement, and integration. Cloud Control can unify the available information, but it cannot expose data or actions that the source system does not provide.

What do you mean by "zero ingestion overhead"?

AI Canvas doesn't copy or store your live operational data. When it needs to answer a question like "what's happening on this switch right now?", it queries the source system in real time and generates the result when the investigation ends. That means no duplicated data, no extra storage costs, and no lag. The exception is inventory and topology, which Cloud Control does normalize and store at the platform level because that data is most valuable when unified across domains. The live telemetry is pulled on demand; inventory and topology are always-on, always-unified.

Does AI Canvas support push notifications from downstream applications?

No. AI Canvas pulls data when needed, as directed by its AI agents. It leverages Model Context Protocol connections to supported platforms. AI Canvas does not passively collect or ingest data.

What is Model Context Protocol (MCP) and why is it important?

Model Context Protocol is a standards-based protocol that enables communication between AI agents and tools (like Meraki or Splunk). It creates an abstraction layer, which allows Cisco to rapidly onboard new products and expand the ecosystem of tools that can be integrated into AI Canvas without the design process of custom, proprietary APIs for each one.

How do specialized Cloud Control agents interact with product MCP servers?

Cisco Cloud Control defines specialized agents for particular operational scopes. Integrated products expose tools and endpoints through their Model Context Protocol servers, which the agents use to retrieve information and perform permitted operations.

Are Cisco's Model Context Protocol servers open source? Can customers extend them?

Currently, Cisco's official Model Context Protocol servers are not open source. However, there is strong interest from the field for reference servers that customers and partners can extend and customize. The Cisco DevNet team tracks both community and official servers at: developer.cisco.com/codeexchange/ai. Future plans around open extensibility are under evaluation.

Will the Deep Network Model (DNM) be available on GitHub?

No. The focus is on integrating DNM into AI Canvas to power troubleshooting and reasoning rather than providing direct model access.

Technical product questions

What is the uptime guarantee as a percent of total available service time?

99.9%

What is the Recovery Time Objective (RTO) in hours?

36 hours

What is the Recovery Point Objective (RPO) in hours?

24 hours

Can your service meet its SLA if the primary hosting region is completely down?

Yes, if multiple regions are available within the customer's country. This currently includes the US, EU, Australia, Japan, and India.

Which browsers support Cisco Cloud Control?

Cisco Cloud Control supports Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox, and Apple Safari. If cross-launching Intersight, Meraki, or ThousandEyes from Firefox causes issues, use a private window.

Can users add serial numbers and other fields to the Cloud Control Inventory table?

Yes. Open the Inventory column selector using the gear icon and select fields such as serial number to add them to the table.

Cisco integrated product-specific questions

Meraki

How many Meraki organizations can be linked to a single Cisco Cloud Control tenant?

Cisco Cloud Control supports a 1:many tenant linking model that will allow multiple Meraki organizations to be associated with a single Cloud Control tenant.

If a customer uses Infrastructure-as-Code (e.g., Meraki-as-Code), how does AI Canvas interact with that?

AI Canvas focuses on operational and telemetry aspects of how to identify problems and identify root causes. It does not make configuration changes that would bypass an as-Code workflow. If a customer uses Infrastructure-as-Code, the single source of truth for configuration remains the code repository. Whether AI Canvas could in the future interact with an as-Code system (rather than direct changes) is an area of active discussion but not a current capability.

How does Meraki Dashboard integration work with Cisco Cloud Control?

Cisco Cloud Control sits above Meraki Dashboard as the unified operational front door, bringing Dashboard's capabilities into a broader, cross-domain experience. Meraki Dashboard serves as the cloud gateway for managing Meraki devices. This integration enables visibility across multiple Meraki organizations while providing the same capabilities and control as in the individual Meraki Dashboard experience including unified AI Assistant and AI Canvas.

Customers who access Cisco products through Cisco Cloud Control gain seamless navigation to Meraki's functionality. For non-Meraki customers, Cisco Cloud Control provides equivalent experiences through alternative cloud gateways such as Intersight for data center products.

How does Cisco Cloud Control differ from Meraki - Catalyst Center Global Overview?

Cisco Cloud Control sits above the Meraki–Catalyst Center Global Overview as the unified operational front door and main point of entry. It brings the Global Overview into a broader, cross-domain experience with a consistent way to access and operate Cisco products from one place. Customers get capability parity through Cloud Control, which means they can access the same Meraki and Catalyst Center Global Overview capabilities through the Cloud Control experience. The vision is that Cloud Control becomes the single place to manage Cisco products.

Catalyst Center

What does the current Catalyst Center integration provide?

The current integration provides inventory, topology, and P1/P2 issue information. AI Canvas, AI Assistant, and direct navigation to Catalyst Center are not currently included in the integration.

Will third-party devices managed by Catalyst Center appear in Cisco Cloud Control?

Yes. If a third-party device is represented in Catalyst Center inventory, it can be included in the inventory synchronized with Cloud Control. Cloud Control topology can also accommodate devices received through this integration.

Does Cisco Cloud Control provide vulnerability information for third-party devices discovered through Catalyst Center?

Not through the Catalyst Center integration. Catalyst Center does not provide third-party vulnerability-scan information to Cloud Control. A separate supported vulnerability-management integration is required for that information.

How will Catalyst Center be integrated into AI Canvas and Cisco Cloud Control?

Catalyst Center integration will initially occur through Meraki Dashboard's Global Overview and Cloud Connect. A simplified integration path with additional feature sets is planned. CCGM is an on-premises Manager of Managers solution and is connected to Cisco Cloud Control today. Customers would need to use the Global Overview capability in Meraki Dashboard to connect Catalyst Centers as mentioned above.

How do on-prem controllers (Catalyst Center, Nexus Dashboard) connect?

Via cloud tethers. Nexus Dashboard connects through Intersight, and Catalyst Center connects through Meraki (Global Overview).

Can on-prem Catalyst switches and routers (without Catalyst Center or Meraki Dashboard) use AI Canvas?

Not at initial release. AI Canvas currently requires a cloud-managed platform (Meraki Dashboard, ThousandEyes, or Splunk Cloud) as the launch point. Catalyst switches managed in Meraki mode (via Meraki Cloud Connect) are included in AI Canvas responses, but on-prem-only Catalyst Center deployments do not have a direct path to AI Canvas at this time.

Catalyst SD-WAN

Does Cisco Cloud Control support Catalyst SD-WAN Manager Cloud Pro?

No. Cisco Cloud Control currently supports Catalyst SD-WAN Manager Cloud, not Catalyst SD-WAN Manager Cloud Pro.

ThousandEyes

What Cisco ThousandEyes capabilities are available in Cisco Cloud Control at launch?

At launch, eligible ThousandEyes customers can access ThousandEyes directly through the Cisco Cloud Control experience, view supported Enterprise Agents in Cloud Control Inventory, and surface supported Cloud and Enterprise Agent alerts in Notification Feed. Major and critical alerts will also appear in Actions. ThousandEyes intelligence is also available in AI Assistant and AI Canvas workflows, helping teams bring network and application performance context into broader Cisco operational investigations. Customers retain access to the full ThousandEyes experience for deeper analysis and workflows.

How does the ThousandEyes integration with Cisco Cloud Control help NetOps teams?

The integration brings ThousandEyes assurance intelligence into context alongside data from other supported Cisco products. NetOps teams can more easily identify issues that may require attention, understand where ThousandEyes assurance is deployed, and use AI Assistant and AI Canvas to investigate performance across enterprise networks and external dependencies. This reduces the need to manually move between tools and reconstruct context during an investigation. It also provides a more context-rich analysis so NetOps teams can see the full end-to-end picture in a single view.

Who can use the ThousandEyes' integration with Cisco Cloud Control?

The initial integration is available to eligible ThousandEyes organizations hosted in the US1 or US2 regions that use Cisco Unified Identity (CUI). An administrator must connect the ThousandEyes organization to the appropriate Cisco Cloud Control tenant group and have the required permissions in both products. Managed service provider organizations are not supported at initial availability. Once connected, access to ThousandEyes information continues to respect the user's existing organization, account-group, and role-based permissions.

Webex Control Hub

Which collaboration devices are included through the Webex Control Hub integration?

The integration includes devices displayed in the Webex Control Hub Devices tab, including Webex Edge-connected devices. On-premises CUCM-registered devices that do not appear in Control Hub are not included.

Cisco IQ

Does Cisco Cloud Control get its inventory and advisory information from Cisco IQ?

Not necessarily. Cisco Cloud Control primarily receives operational data from its connected Cisco product controllers and other supported sources.

For example, inventory, last-date-of-support information, PSIRT or security advisory information, firmware versions, and affected-device details may come from controller-side inventory and advisory data, Cisco advisory or CVE sources, or other sources connected to Cloud Control. The presence of this information in Cloud Control does not by itself indicate that it came from Cisco IQ.

Cisco IQ has a different data path and value model. It can receive data through sources such as CX Collector and adds lifecycle, entitlement, assessment, support-posture, advisory-prioritization, and services context.

What is synchronized between Cisco IQ and Cisco Cloud Control today?

The synchronization currently being discussed is focused on inventory and asset alignment. It should not be described as a complete bidirectional synchronization of metadata, advisories, assessments, recommendations, or operational insights.

The longer-term relationship between IQ-derived context and Cloud Control insights still needs to be defined more explicitly. For example, future integration could determine whether IQ-derived advisory metadata appears in Cloud Control or whether Cloud Control-generated operational insights appear in Cisco IQ. Sellers should not position those flows as available unless they have been specifically confirmed.

What is the difference between Cisco Cloud Control inventory and Cisco IQ inventory?

Cisco Cloud Control provides an operational view of assets known through its connected controllers and supported data sources. It helps operators understand the current environment, including inventory, status, relationships, topology, and other operational context exposed by those sources.

Cisco IQ provides a lifecycle- and services-oriented asset view. It can add context such as:

- Assets discovered through CX Collector
- Support and contract entitlement
- Lifecycle and end-of-support information
- Cisco IQ assessments
- Support posture
- Advisory prioritization
- CX advisory context
- Cross-asset recommendations generated through the Cisco IQ data model

The two platforms may contain overlapping assets and information, but they organize and enrich that information for different operational jobs.

If Cisco IQ and Cisco Cloud Control connect to the same controllers, can they show similar information?

Yes. If Cisco IQ and Cisco Cloud Control are independently connected to the same controllers or underlying data sources, they may derive similar or overlapping inventory, lifecycle, or advisory information.

That does not mean Cisco IQ is consuming Cloud Control insights or that Cloud Control is consuming Cisco IQ insights. Directly using one platform's insights within the other requires an explicit integration or linking model.

Without that integration, each platform works from the sources and context it can access independently.

What can Cisco Cloud Control show if it is not integrated with Cisco IQ?

Cisco Cloud Control can still show information available natively from connected controllers, CX Collector where supported, and other connected sources. Depending on the source and integration, this may include:

- Inventory and affected devices
- Last-date-of-support information
- Firmware versions
- PSIRT or other security advisory information
- Controller health, status, and topology
- Operational alerts and telemetry

The exact information available depends on what each connected source exposes. Sellers should avoid implying that every controller provides the same fields or depth of context.

What additional value does Cisco IQ integration provide?

Cisco IQ integration becomes additive when it contributes context that Cloud Control would not otherwise have. Examples may include:

- CX Collector-discovered assets not already known to Cloud Control
- Support and contract entitlement context
- Cisco IQ assessments
- Lifecycle risk prioritization
- CX advisory context
- Services engagement context
- Cross-asset recommendations generated from the Cisco IQ data model

This is the stronger differentiation: Cisco IQ enriches the operational view with lifecycle, support, services, and prioritization context rather than simply duplicating controller data.

How do Cisco IQ and Cisco Cloud Control complement each other?

Cisco IQ and Cisco Cloud Control are complementary, AI-native experiences with different primary jobs.

Cisco Cloud Control is the unified operations platform. It helps teams understand and operate the live environment using data and capabilities exposed by connected controllers and supported sources.

Cisco IQ is the digital experience for Cisco Support and Professional Services. It helps customers understand lifecycle position, support posture, assessments, entitlements, services engagements, and prioritized risk across their technology estate.

Together, the intended value is to connect lifecycle intelligence with operational execution. However, sellers should distinguish the intended complementary experience from integrations that are confirmed and available today.

Nexus Dashboard

When we talk about Nexus Dashboard connecting to Cisco Cloud Control, is that for both LAN and SAN?

Currently, it is LAN. The SAN integration is on medium term roadmap.

Can standalone NX-OS switches be onboarded directly without Nexus Dashboard?

No. Cisco Cloud Control onboards supported controllers rather than unmanaged devices directly. Standalone NX-OS environments require a supported controller or aggregation path, such as Nexus Dashboard.

Can Cisco Cloud Control connect directly to APIC for ACI visibility?

No. ACI is brought into Cisco Cloud Control through Nexus Dashboard, with Nexus Dashboard connected through Intersight. Direct APIC onboarding is not supported.

Security Cloud Control

How does Cisco Cloud Control differ from and overlap with Security Cloud Control? Will they merge?

Cisco Cloud Control is the natural evolution and expansion of Security Cloud Control's success. While Security Cloud Control focused specifically on security products, Cisco Cloud Control extends unified management capabilities across your entire Cisco

portfolio—networking, security, observability, and collaboration—in a single environment with one login, one inventory, and one topology.

Security Cloud Control operates as a partner controller within this architecture and will not merge with Cisco Cloud Control at this time. This means Security Cloud Control remains fully functional for specialized security work, and operators can seamlessly navigate between Cisco Cloud Control (the unified front door) and Security Cloud Control for deeper security-specific operations. Security is fully represented and accessible within the Cloud Control dashboard, so you get both the unified cross-domain view and the ability to access specialized security capabilities when needed.

Why was Cisco Cloud Control created instead of just expanding Security Cloud Control (SCC)?

Cisco Cloud Control was created because the customer problem is broader than security. Security Cloud Control is the security operating plane. It is built for security personas and security workflows: firewall and policy management, security device onboarding, zero-trust segmentation, application protection, tenant/customer security operations, and security-specific automation.

Cloud Control addresses the cross-portfolio operations problem. Customers need a unified way to manage identity, tenant context, inventory, topology, workflows, AI, and operational insights across Networking, Security, Observability, Compute, Collaboration, and other Cisco domains.

So the answer was not to expand SCC into everything. That would risk turning a security-focused platform into a generic portfolio layer. Instead, CCC provides the broader One Cisco operating model, while SCC retains the depth needed for security use cases."

Splunk

Where can I view the complete, detailed Splunk and Cisco Cloud Control FAQ?

You can access it here: [Splunk and Cisco Cloud Control FAQ](#).

When will the Splunk integration be available for Cisco Cloud Control?

Today, Splunk Cloud 10.5 is available in Cloud Control and AI Canvas (CA).

Coming September 14th:

- Splunk Cloud 10.6 in Cloud Control and AI Canvas GA
- Splunk ITSI and Splunk Observability in Cloud Control and AI Canvas GA

- Splunk Enterprise Security in Cloud Control and AI Canvas Beta

Does Cloud Control with AI Canvas replace Splunk?

No. Cisco Cloud Control with AI Canvas and Splunk perform different, complementary roles.

Splunk provides the data foundation for collecting, retaining, searching, and correlating telemetry across Cisco and third-party environments. It helps teams understand what happened over time, identify patterns, and connect events across applications, infrastructure, security, and business services.

Cisco Cloud Control provides a unified operational experience across supported Cisco products. It brings together live controller context such as inventory, topology, health, policy, and configuration state.

AI Canvas operates within Cisco Cloud Control. It brings relevant controller context and, where integrated, Splunk data into a collaborative workspace where operators and AI agents can investigate issues, determine next steps, and carry out supported actions with appropriate controls.

In simple terms:

- Splunk provides broad, historical, and cross-environment data context.
- Cisco Cloud Control provides a unified view of the current Cisco operational environment.
- AI Canvas helps teams investigate, decide, and act using the available context.

Customers can use Cisco Cloud Control without Splunk for supported built-in use cases. Splunk becomes especially valuable when the customer needs deeper historical analysis, high-volume data retention, service-level correlation, or broader multivendor context.

Does Cloud Control leverage the Cisco Data Fabric (powered by Splunk)?

Cisco Data Fabric can complement Cisco Cloud Control in two ways.

First, Splunk and Cisco Data Fabric can provide data, analytics, correlation, and historical context for supported Cloud Control and AI Canvas workflows.

Second, Cisco Cloud Control can provide a unified operational experience through which users access relevant Splunk context alongside live information from connected Cisco controllers.

The result is a complementary architecture:

- Cisco Data Fabric helps unify, manage, and analyze operational data at scale.
- Cisco Cloud Control provides the operational context and experience across supported Cisco products.
- AI Canvas uses the available context to support investigation, collaboration, and governed action.

The exact Cisco Data Fabric capabilities used by Cisco Cloud Control will depend on the workflow, integration, entitlement, and product release.

Are FedRAMP customers eligible for Cisco Cloud Control Controlled?

No, FedRAMP customers are not eligible for the Cisco Cloud Control at this time. We are working towards to required certifications.

How can I get access to Cisco Cloud Control as a Splunk customer?

All users in the Splunk – Cisco Cloud Control (US AWS Commercial) Cohort are enrolled in Cisco Identity when the stack is updated to Splunk 10.5. On first login, users are prompted to verify their email address. Email verification is required for Cisco Cloud Control access, but users can continue using Splunk normally if they skip it.

A Splunk administrator must request a demo through cloud.cisco.com or contact their account team. Once the demo request is approved, the onboarding team will schedule a call and enable access. The administrator must then complete the Cisco Cloud Control onboarding process and accept the Cisco General Terms on behalf of the organization.

End users do not complete onboarding and cannot accept terms on behalf of the organization. Until an admin completes onboarding and accepts the Cisco General Terms, non-admin users will not see the Cisco Cloud Control logo and will not be able to navigate to Cloud Control. After onboarding is complete, Cisco Cloud Control is available to users who have verified their email. For more questions about onboarding, check the full FAQ linked above.

Why are users being prompted to verify their email address?

Email verification is a mandatory security prerequisite for cross-product authorization. Because Cisco Cloud Control and Splunk share data and resources, Cisco Identity requires a verified, stable identifier (email) to ensure that your permissions and Role-Based Access Controls (RBAC) are correctly applied across the entire Cisco ecosystem. For more information, check out this [blog](#).

Talk tracks for Splunk Field

“Why do I have to sign up for another Cisco platform just to use an AI feature?”

Cisco Cloud Control is not just another portal. It is, and will be, the place to operate and manage your Cisco portfolio. It includes single sign-on, so you sign in once to manage all of your Cisco products from one place. AI Canvas is the big opportunity here: it lets your teams and AI agents work together across every domain, and it brings AI to all of your Cisco investments, not just Splunk. Sign-up is a one-time process for your organization.

“We only have Splunk. Why do we need Cloud Control?”

All US commercial customers are now eligible for Cloud Control, even if you only have Splunk. You will get AI Canvas to query your Splunk data in natural language. And as Cisco expands Cloud Control, you will be positioned to benefit from future cross-product capabilities with no additional setup. Your Splunk tenant works standalone, so you do not have to link it to other products to get value today.

“The approval process is too slow. We want access now.”

The controlled rollout ensures a quality experience for every customer. Single-product Splunk customers are being considered for fast-tracking. If this is a strategic or time-sensitive situation, we can escalate through the account team to request prioritized approval. Reach out to the Splunk and Cisco Cloud Control Product teams with any requests.

“Will this change how my Splunk works? Is Splunk changing?”

No. Splunk continues to work exactly as it does today. In fact, Cloud Control enhances the value of your Splunk investment and the rest of your Cisco investments. The only visible change is a new navigation icon for Cloud Control and AI Canvas after your admin completes onboarding. All your existing workflows, dashboards, alerts, and permissions are unchanged.

“What if we don’t want Cloud Control?”

Cloud Control is how Cisco is delivering AI Canvas and future cross-product experiences. If a customer does not wish to use Cloud Control, they can continue using Splunk as-is; the core Splunk product is unaffected.

Identity in Cisco Cloud Control

What is Cisco Identity?

Cisco Identity brings all customer-facing identity capabilities together in the “Identity” tab within Cisco Cloud Control. Cisco Identity gives teams a unified experience and visibility

into their human identities, agents, endpoints, and service accounts. Teams can monitor identity activity, identify suspicious behavior, investigate anomalies, and take action – all from one experience.

What is included in Cisco Identity today?

Cisco Identity provides unified visibility across all human and non-human identities (employees, contractors, devices, AI agents, service accounts). Capabilities include:

- Real-time anomaly detection for suspicious behavior
- Identity risk analytics and reporting for compliance and audits
- Correlation of identity data across connected systems to show who has access to what
- Historical access timelines and activity tracking
- Monitoring and detection of suspicious identity behavior

Cisco Identity is natively integrated into Cisco Cloud Control. It connects with Cloud Control platform services, such as unified inventory, and agentic capabilities like AI Canvas. This provides identity visibility in the context of a customer's entire security posture rather than a separate, siloed identity tool.

How do ISE customers benefit from Cisco Identity today?

For ISE customers, Cisco Identity unlocks cloud-based monitoring and analytics that weren't available with on-prem-only ISE deployments. Customers do not need to buy additional hardware or host the service in their own cloud. Customers have a centralized view of all ISE deployments with cross-deployment visibility. It also provides customers with the latest features without needing to manually upgrade.

What is included with Cisco Identity, and what requires an additional license?

Identity in Cisco Cloud Control for Cisco products is included at no additional cost. To add non-Cisco integrations, customers need Duo Advantage or ISE Advantage.

Included with Cisco Cloud Control, for all customers:

- Integrations with supported Cisco products, including ISE, Duo, Splunk, Secure Access and Webex
- Identity visibility across Cisco security portfolio:
 - Cloud Control Inventory integration

- AI Canvas integration
- Notifications via Webex and Splunk
- Basic analytics and monitoring

Requires Duo Advantage or ISE Advantage:

- Non-Cisco integrations (Okta, Active Directory, GitHub, etc.)
- Advanced analytics and anomaly detection across all integrated systems

What is the difference between Cisco Unified Identity and Cisco Identity?

Cisco Unified Identity (CUI) is a feature for admins who manage Cisco products. It provides federated login and tenancy management in Admin Console for Cloud Control. CUI is an internal term, not a customer-facing product term.

Cisco Identity is the customer-facing capability you sell. It is the solution customers buy and use to monitor all identities (human and non-human) across their organization.

Do all integrated products follow the same Cisco Unified Identity onboarding process?

No. Cisco Unified Identity readiness and onboarding steps vary by product and region. Customers should follow the current product-specific prerequisites rather than assume one migration process applies across the portfolio.

Security, governance, and AI trust

How does Cisco Cloud Control with AI Canvas ensure privacy and protect customer data?

AI Canvas is designed so telemetry stays where it lives. The platform queries live data directly from source systems rather than a copy of or relocation of it, reduction in compliance risk and preservation of data ownership. Access controls and permissions from the source platforms are enforced, and all actions and decisions are captured in audit-ready records with clear provenance. Check the Cisco Cloud Control offer document for more details on data residency.

Where can customers find security, privacy, and compliance information for Cisco Cloud Control and AI Canvas?

Customers can find current security, privacy, compliance, and data-handling information in the Cisco Trust Portal. Consult the offer disclosures for both Cisco Cloud Control and AI Canvas.

How does role-based access control (RBAC) work?

Cloud Control with AI Canvas honor each user's entitlements and permissions based on what is configured on the underlying integrated platforms (Meraki, Security Cloud Control, ThousandEyes, etc.). A user's ability to view data or execute changes is determined by their existing permissions in the source platforms. If a user lacks access to a data source, they will not be able to view the corresponding data within the workspace. Unless they are a full tenant admin... in which case they can see the data in the workspace but cannot open any of the products they are not part of.

How does role-based access control work if an administrator has different permission levels across different Cisco platforms?

Role-based access control is respected across the board. For example, if you enter a colleague's shared workspace and they have widgets for a platform you don't have access to (e.g., Nexus Dashboard), you will not be able to view the data for those widgets. Your access level is always governed by the source platform's permissions.

Exception for full tenant administrators: If you are a full tenant administrator, you can see all data within the Cloud Control workspace. However, you cannot open or access any individual product dashboards (Meraki, Intersight, etc.) for which you do not have explicit permissions in that product. This ensures that administrative visibility within Cloud Control does not inadvertently grant access to underlying product consoles.

For Read-only users: If you have read-only access, you will be able to view data across all products you have permissions for, but you cannot execute configurations. Your access level is always determined by your entitlements in the source platforms—Cloud Control enforces these permissions at all times.

How is role-based access control (RBAC) implemented, and does it support multi-tenancy for MSPs?

For Managed Service Providers (MSPs), Cisco Cloud Control's multi-tenancy capabilities are on the roadmap for FY2027, enabling MSPs to securely manage highly distributed customer environments. MSP-specific features currently in development include improved multi-tenancy controls and role-based visibility isolation.

How does AI Canvas ensure its recommendations are safe and accurate?

AI Canvas prioritizes safety and accuracy through an "Operator-first" model and its ensemble of specialized AI: Cisco Deep Network Model: When networking expertise is required, guidance is grounded in decades of Cisco engineering expertise, validated designs, and real operational data (not generic public models). Ensemble Intelligence: The

platform selects the best-fit model for each task and specialized accuracy across different problem types. Explainable Reasoning: Every recommendation shows the telemetry evaluated, the checks performed, and what remains uncertain. Governed Execution: Supported actions require explicit human approval, respect existing role-based access controls, and produce audit-ready records. Where applicable, workflows include validation steps and rollback guidance.

How is user feedback incorporated into the model?

The models use a multi-step training pipeline incorporating Cisco documentation, expert feedback, support (TAC) data, and continual retraining based on new data and user input. Expert feedback, especially from CCIEs, is central to model improvement. Feedback is reviewed, gaps are identified, and updates are made to the training and evaluation pipelines.

How does the Cisco Deep Network Model ensure the privacy and quality of its training data?

The model uses a multi-step training pipeline which incorporates Cisco documentation, expert feedback, support (TAC) data, and continual retraining based on new data and user input. Data governance practices are applied throughout the pipeline to ensure quality and protect privacy.

How do I reassure a security or IT leader worried about AI making autonomous changes?

Tell them the customer stays in control by design. Cloud Control supports two modes they can set per agent and per task: Approval required (human-in-the-loop) is used when the agent proposes and the human approves each action. Use for high-risk or sensitive changes. Monitored autonomy (human-on-the-loop) is used when the agent acts on routine tasks, while the human monitors and can override. Use for well-defined operational work. Every agent action is scoped by the customer's existing RBAC, logged with full provenance, and auditable end-to-end. Cisco AI Defense enforces data policy at every model interaction; Splunk AI Agent Monitoring traces every execution. Customer data is never used to train foundation models. Customers decide what AI is permitted to do, and the platform enforces it with no exceptions.

How does Cisco Cloud Control help with CVE and vulnerability management at scale?

AI Canvas on Cisco Cloud Control is how defenders fight AI with AI: a program built to match Glasswing's pace, turning manual CVE triage into an automated, governed Vulnerability Management Program.

Your CVE war room can be converted to a Vulnerability Management Program in a single afternoon. Rather than replacing existing CVE tools or CX platforms, Cloud Control integrates data from your current sources and layers on intelligent correlation and orchestration. The out-of-the-box Vulnerability Management board automates the workflow end-to-end:

Auto-ingests every new CVE in real time
Enriches findings with KEV (Known Exploited Vulnerabilities), EPSS scores, and exploit-in-the-wild intelligence
Correlates each vulnerability to your live assets and real exposure via Cloud Control telemetry
Provides AI-recommended actions with full rationale for every decision
Orchestrates fixes end-to-end—in minutes

Demonstration and integration:

The pre-built Vulnerability Management board is ready out-of-the-box for customer demos, showcasing live CVE ingestion, asset correlation, and AI-recommended remediation workflows. Cisco IQ integration is a planned fast-follow, adding lifecycle context so customers know not just which vulnerabilities to fix, but when and how each asset fits into their broader lifecycle and support roadmap. For a demo tailored to your Catalyst Center environment or to discuss integration with your current processes, contact your regional SE Champion."

Roadmap, deployment, and getting started

Is Cisco Cloud Control available globally at launch?

No. For the General Availability (GA) in August 2026, it is regionally hosted in the United States only. Customers with US-based infrastructure can participate.

Where will a user access AI Canvas?

AI Canvas is accessible only through Cisco Cloud Control. Cisco Cloud Control is the main point of entry. It can be cross-launched via Splunk Dashboard.

Can customers access Cisco Cloud Control if they are not in the USA?

Yes, but this is currently limited by data sovereignty requirements. If the customer does not have data sovereignty requirements, the platform is accessible. Support for additional geographic regions is planned.

Where can I learn how to onboard my customer?

You can learn on the Onboarding SharePoint site here:

<https://cisco.sharepoint.com/sites/CiscoCloudControl-ControlledAvailability/SitePages/Home.aspx>

When will Cisco Cloud Control be available in specific regions (EU, APJ, LATAM)?

Cisco Cloud Control launches in the United States with General Availability on August 25, 2026. Expansion to additional regions is driven by market demand and data sovereignty requirements.

Will there be on-premises or air-gapped deployments of Cisco Cloud Control?

Cisco Cloud Control is delivered as a SaaS solution in the cloud with immediate focus on global, multi-region cloud availability. For customers with on-premises data sources, Cisco Cloud Control uses a gateway/tether approach to bring required visibility into the cloud management plane—for example, on-premises Catalyst Center connects via Meraki Dashboard, on-premises Nexus Dashboard via Intersight, and on-premises SD-WAN via Security Cloud Control. Support for on-premises deployments and eventually air-gapped environments are on the product roadmap. Immediate focus is on expanding multi-region cloud availability and on-premises "on-net" (customer private datacenter) connectivity before tackling fully air-gapped solutions. A strategy for air-gapped deployments is under development, but no committed timeline has been announced.

Can AI Canvas run on something like the Cisco AI Pod?

The idea of exposing AI Canvas via Cisco AI Pod has been raised and is being tracked, but there is no confirmed plan at this time. The initial focus remains on cloud-based delivery.

Who is the target audience for Cisco Cloud Control?

Cisco Cloud Control is designed for IT and security operations teams who manage Cisco environments across network operations, network observability, security and collaboration. This especially includes customers who operate at scale and need a unified operational experience.

What qualifies as a "high-probability" Cisco Cloud Control opportunity?

Strong indicators of a high-probability customer for Cloud control include: Two or more Cisco domains deployed (e.g., Meraki + Security Cloud Control, or Catalyst Center + Intersight) Active complaints about tool fragmentation, alert overload, or slow cross-team investigations Existing interest in AI or automation for IT operations Cloud-managed architecture preference (or migration in progress) An operations leader (VP I&O, CIO, Head

of NetOps) sponsoring modernization A customer with even one of these signals is worth a Cloud Control conversation.

What disqualifies a customer today?

Customers whose environments are exclusively on-prem with no cloud-managed footprint have limited launch-day value. Customers with no controller managed devices or strict air-gapped requirements and no acceptable SaaS path are not a current fit. Customers with no subscription-eligible Cisco products won't gain entitlement. These aren't permanent disqualifiers, just roadmap gaps.

What kind of training will be required for IT teams to use AI Canvas effectively?

The design emphasizes an intuitive user experience powered by a natural language AI Assistant, with the goal of reducing the learning curve. Enablement resources will be provided to help teams adapt to the new collaborative, cross-domain workflow. A formal training curriculum will be detailed as the platform matures.

Is there a demo environment available for Cisco Cloud Control?

Yes. You can demo through dCloud today. It is a live environment. Link: <https://dcloud2-sjc.cisco.com/content/instantdemo/agentcops-with-cisco-cloud-control>

Can Cisco Cloud Control open integrated product dashboards in separate browser tabs? Can a user have multiple dashboards open at once without closing tabs?

No. That is not currently possible. The only way is to currently duplicate the tab and then open a different dashboard in each.

Where can I ask more questions?

Post all questions about Cisco Cloud Control including AI Canvas in the Ask Cisco Cloud Control space: <https://eurl.io/#Q9x8Xqd2f>

How can I arrange a customer discovery session with the product team?

Reach out to your regional Champion to coordinate a customer conversation. You can find your champion at the SE Champions SharePoint site: <https://cisco.sharepoint.com/sites/CiscoAICanvasChampions>

Is there a central resource for information?

You can view the official SalesConnect:

<https://salesresources.cisco.com/Link/Content/DCPRq9gcFP6PF8QTWQFJm3MF47PB>